

March 21, 2026

Warnock Supports Global Disability Rights Legislation, Announces Vote for S. 5628

Senator Warnock uses floor speech to highlight the need to expand civil rights and inclusion in U.S. foreign policy.

Senator Warnock voted to pass the [State Department Disability Policy and Accommodations Act](#).

This bill would establish an international disability rights strategy and an Ambassador-at-Large to run the efforts.

Senator Warnock: “our commitment to civil rights and justice must include every person, in every place, or else it is meaningless”

Washington, D.C. – Today, Senator Reverend Raphael Warnock (D-GA) announced his support for S. 5628, the State Department Disability Policy and Accommodations Act, and his intention to vote in favor of its passage. During remarks on the Senate floor, Senator Warnock discussed the importance of expanding disability inclusion as part of the United States’ global leadership on human rights. During his remarks, Senator Warnock highlighted the scale and urgency of the issue.

“I could not ignore that there are more than one billion people around the world living with disabilities that are often pushed into the margins of society,” said Senator Warnock. **“These individuals face barriers to education, employment, health care, and life in general. As I think about these individuals, I consider this legislation to be both necessary and just.”**

The State Department Disability Policy and Accommodations Act would require that the State Department works to develop a strategy that would integrate disability rights into foreign aid, diplomacy, and humanitarian efforts. Also, it would create an Office of International Disability Rights that would be led by an Ambassador-at-Large, who would work to coordinate efforts across federal agencies and our international partners. The bill is expected to impact the Department of State, the United States Agency for International Development (USAID), nongovernmental organizations, and disability advocates worldwide by promoting accessibility, accountability, and teamwork around the world.

Senator Warnock also acknowledged the work required to effectively implement this policy. **“The difficulty of the work does not erase the necessity of it,”** he said. **“If anything, it reminds us why the work needs to be done.”**

This bill reflects that the U.S. is willing to strengthen our democracy, build economic opportunities, and advance global human rights. Senator Warnock supports this bill, noting that it aligns with his lifelong fight towards civil rights for all.